

Giuseppe Santoro

Senior Platform Engineer

 [gsantoro \(GitHub\)](#)

 [santorogiuseppe](#)

 [Cloud Native Engineer \(Newsletter\)](#)

 [gsantoro \(Leetcode\)](#)

SUMMARY

Senior Platform Engineer with 13+ years in cloud infrastructure and distributed systems. Expert in Kubernetes, Terraform/GitOps, Observability (Prometheus, Loki, Mimir, Tempo, Grafana), and multi-cloud (AWS/GCP). Track record supporting global product launches at Elastic and PlayStation; currently driving AI-augmented platform engineering at Loveholidays to reduce operational toil and MTTR.

SKILLS

- **Cloud & Kubernetes:** GCP (GKE, BigQuery), Kubernetes (4+ years, multi-region GKE), AWS (Lambda, S3, ECS, EMR, Glue, Athena)
- **AI / LLM Engineering:** Claude Agent SDK, MCP development, Claude Skills, Claude Code / Codex
- **Observability:** Prometheus, Loki, Mimir, Tempo, Grafana
- **Infrastructure-as-Code & GitOps:** Terraform, Atlantis, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, Renovate
- **Data & Analytics:** BigQuery, dbt, Looker, Streamlit
- **Programming:** Python (10 years), Golang (6 years)

EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer

July 2025 - Present

Loveholidays

Cloud Infrastructure Team

- Resolved 300+ investigations across 60+ support days (on-call + working-hours) for 70+ engineers on £5m **GKE** infrastructure (12k+ peak containers, 349 nodes, 13+ TiB persistent storage) using Terraform, ArgoCD, and observability tools.
- Built autonomous Claude **AI Slack bot** reducing alert investigation time **10-15x (20-30min → 1-2min)** using **Claude Agent SDK**, custom MCP servers, and Python on Kubernetes—triggered via emoji reaction for zero-friction on-call triage.
- Delivered zero-effort **Terraform** drift detection across 2 monorepos managing 486 applications via Atlantis post-workflow hooks + GitHub Actions, surfacing infrastructure divergence daily with Slack alerts.
- Built escalations data product joining incident.io API + historical PagerDuty data in BigQuery with dbt transforms and Looker dashboards, exposing escalation patterns for root cause analysis.
- Automated platform team toil via 10+ **Claude Skills** (daily standups, GitHub PR automation, ISO-27001 compliance evidence, infrastructure research), reaching 84.85% AI adoption vs. 61% company baseline.

Senior Software Engineer

May 2024 - March 2025

Elastic

Platform org - Developer Experience Team

- Built **Playwright**-based synthetic monitoring framework helping 8+ teams reduce production issues during Elastic Cloud Serverless launch; served as **Incident Commander**.
- Rolled out **Renovate** company-wide to eliminate dependency drift across codebases.

Senior Software Engineer

March 2022 - May 2024

Elastic

Observability org - Cloud Native Team

- Enabled cluster-local debugging of **Elastic Beats** on **Kubernetes** via Go Delve + Tilt integration, eliminating slow local-only debug cycles for cloud-native development.
- Shipped Elastic integration for **Istio** service mesh (logs + metrics) enabling out-of-the-box performance monitoring.
- Built specialized dashboards improving Kubernetes cluster visibility within Elastic integration.
- Resolved complex customer Kubernetes deployment escalations while contributing upstream bug fixes to Elastic codebases.

Big Data Engineer

October 2018 - August 2021

PlayStation

Game Analytics Team

- Cut analytics query latency from minutes to seconds via custom **Golang** tool over AWS S3/ **Athena** /Glue, unblocking studio analysts.
- Built real-time event processor on **AWS Lambda** + **Python** enabling cross-event correlation batch pipelines couldn't deliver.

- Delivered end-to-end support for **10+ PlayStation game launches** across application development and AWS infrastructure.
 - Accelerated Studio Engineers' media content discovery via Python video transcoding tool.
 - Operated 10+ microservices, 20+ **EMR** jobs, 5+ **Lambda** functions reliably in small-team environment.
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Senior Software Engineer

March 2017 - August 2018

Skimlinks

Platform Team

- Reduced ingestion runtime for 120M-document **Elasticsearch** pipeline via **Google Dataflow**, replacing slower batch approach.
 - Migrated data pipeline from on-premise Hadoop to **Google BigQuery**, improving query performance and reducing operational cost.
 - Automated pipeline scheduling via **Airflow** on **Kubernetes** replacing brittle cron-based orchestration—gained visibility into pipeline state and failures.
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Software Engineer

July 2015 - February 2017

BenevolentAI (formerly Stratified Medical)

Platform Team

- Cut **Elasticsearch** ingestion 8x (24h → 3h) on 40M scientific publications via **Spark** multi-threading + **S3** storage.
 - Automated pipeline scheduling via Python Airflow jobs replacing manual orchestration.
 - Developed and maintained applications on **Apache Mesos and Marathon** (Kubernetes predecessors).
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Senior Software Engineer

November 2013 - July 2015

Big Data Partnership (acquired by Teradata)

Training & Consulting

- Delivered official Hortonworks Hadoop course at Hadoop Summit for 2 years + 5 private corporate engagements with 90% positive feedback.
 - Led **3-engineer team** in 4-month greenfield consulting project delivering complete client solution end-to-end.
 - Achieved high certification scores on Hadoop developer and administrator exams within months of self-study.
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CERTIFICATION

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

2023 - 2025

Linux Foundation

Demonstrated expertise in both development and administration of Kubernetes clusters, including application deployment, and production troubleshooting.

EXTRAS

Technical Writer

June 2023 - Present

Cloud Native Engineer Newsletter

- Built 2,800+ subscriber audience with 4.7K monthly views creating cloud-native technical content.
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Technical Mentor

June 2023 - Present

MentorCruise (paid mentoring platform)

- Reached Top Mentor status on MentorCruise (5-star ratings, 10+ reviews, 30+ mentees) coaching junior/senior engineers for interviews and startup CTOs/CEOs on system design.
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EDUCATION

Master's in Computer Science (Software Engineering)

2006 - 2012

University of Catania

Graduated with honors (110/110 cum laude)

Bachelor's in Computer Science (Software Engineering)

2002 - 2006

University of Palermo

Graduated with honors (110/110 cum laude)